

Wide Sargasso Sea

Part 2

- In Part 2, the unnamed narrator is Rochester
- The perspective reveals more complex Rochester
 - confused and alienated
- After marriage, they come to Annette's estate called Granbois (High Woods) near a town called Massacre (ominous)
- Half-caste servant Amelie "so full of delighted malice"
- Rochester's attitude towards his wife
 - "watched critically" (30)
 - "dark alien eyes... not English or European"
 - "debased French patois"
- Rochester's fever "I am not myself yet" (30)

- Rochester is overwhelmed by the nature "not only wild but menacing"
- "Everything is too much" (31)
- His longing for recognition from his father "I will never be a disgrace to you"
- He views his marriage as business transaction- not a "bad bargain" (32)
- He becomes more suspicious of natives and the place as "savage" – Christophine looking at him "not with approval"
- His letter to his father shows he is married because of his father's financial arrangement ; his "confused impressions"
- His "faultless performance" (35) as a loving husband

- Rochester appears confused and remembers partially about the wedding
- When Antoinette tries to cancel the wedding, he fears humiliation of being a "rejected suitor jilted by this Creole girl" and makes a deal with her "I'll trust you if you'll trust me. Is that a bargain?" (37)
- Rochester is attracted to Antoinette's beauty (38)
- Reality is becoming elusive, blurring the line between reality vs dream
 - Both feel "unreal" about the other
 - England "a cold dark dream"
 - West Indies "unreal and like a dream"
- Nature imagery
 - Crushed frangipani wreath flowers – male brutality (34); warning "it will bring cockroach in the house" (40)
 - A badly burned moths – death by fire (39)
 - A story about enormous rats – symbol of her anxiety and emotional fragility
 - dropping rose petals (42) – loss of innocence and decay

- Rochester's dislike for Christophine, her language, behavior and dress – his cultural arrogance and inability to understand Others
- Antoinette identifies with the Caribbean world - "You don't understand at all" (40) "I'm very lazy you know, Like Christophine"
- Rochester's desire to dominate "wild, untouched... it kept its secret... What I see is nothing – I want what it *hides* – that is not nothing." (43)
- Rochester feels discomfort seeing Antoinette's close relationship with Christophine
- Antoinette's morbidity & her sense of doom
- Antoinette's "talk of death" (45) "I am not used to happiness... it makes me afraid (46)

- Rochester's lust for her, "savage desire" "not love" (46)
- He regards her as an ignorant, stubborn child (vs submissive English wife) "Nothing that I told her influenced her at all"
- Amelie hands him a letter from Daniel Cosway, illegitimate & poor half-brother, warning about Antoinette's madness
- Resentment towards Old Cosway "wicked and detestable slave-owners" "disgusting goings on"
- He claims that it is his "Christian duty" to warn him that she is "no girl to marry with the bad blood she have from both sides." "Crazy wife in our bed. Crazy and worse besides"
- Rochester's confirmation about his suspicion about Antoinette

- Daniel Cosway stages himself as someone who knows the 'truth' and has the secret knowledge
- But he deliberately tries to provoke suspicions about Antoinette and poison Rochester's mind against her
- His motivations - he feels excluded from the Cosway/Mason family inheritance and wants to destroy her
- Rochester's calm reaction – the letter confirms his suspicions "I felt no surprise. It was as if I'd expected it, been waiting for it"

- Fight between Antoinette & Amelie, when Amelie hints that Rochester doesn't love her (51)
- Amelie insults her by calling and singing the song about a "white cockroach"
- Christophine threatens Amelie to be "quiet and decent"
- Rochester thinks about English way of restraining one's emotions vs the native's "melodramatic, unreal" face